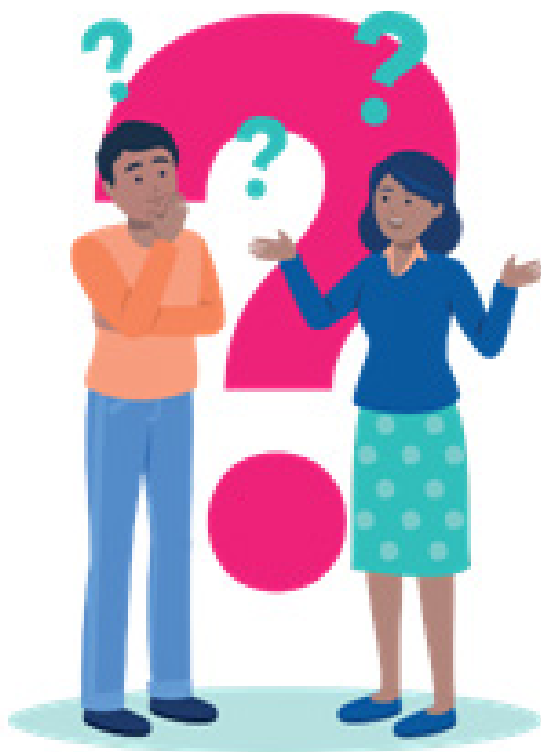




Ministry of Health

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS



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COMBINED ORAL CONTRACEPTIVES (COCs)

1. When should I start using COCs?

You can start COCs as soon as your baby is 6 months and older and any other time when you are not pregnant.

2. If I have been taking COCs for a long time, will I still be protected from becoming pregnant after I stop taking them?

No. You are only protected if you are taking your pills correctly and consistently.

3. How long will it take for me to become pregnant after stopping COCs?

You will become pregnant almost immediately after you stop using COCs. However, return to fertility differs from one woman to another.

4. Will I gain weight when using COCs?

Not always. Weight gain or weight loss differs from one woman to another.

5. Can COCs lower my sex drive?

Not always. Sex drive in women are dependent on many factors including health status, social economic and the relationship with companion.



COMBINED ORAL CONTRACEPTIVES (COCs)

6. If I have varicose veins can I use COCs?

Yes. COCs are safe for women with varicose veins after medical assessment. However, a woman who has a confirmed deep vein thrombosis (DVT) should NOT use COCs.

7. If I am a smoker can I use COCs?

Yes. However, a medical assessment for eligibility is required

8. Can I use COCs as emergency contraceptive pills after unprotected sex?

Yes. COCs can be used as emergency with guidance from a health care provider.

9. Can COCs affect my monthly periods?

Yes. COCs can cause spotting, slightly increased bleeding or no periods at all. These effects go away with time.

10. Is it important for me to take COCs at the same time each day?

Yes. If taken at the same time, it may reduce side effects and will help you remember to take your pills consistently

Remember!



COCs - will not protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



PROGESTIN-ONLY PILLS (POPS)

1. When should I start using POPs after child birth?

You can start POPs immediately after child birth up to 6 months.

2. If I am breastfeeding, can I use POPs?

Yes. You can use POPs while breastfeeding until your baby is 6 months old. POPs do not affect breast milk production.

3. How long will it take for me to become pregnant after stopping POPs?

You will become pregnant almost immediately after you stop using POPs. However, return to fertility differs from one woman to another.

4. Is it important for me to take POPs at the same time each day?

Yes. If taken at the same time, it may reduce side effects and will help you remember to take your pills consistently.

5. Do POPs cause cancer?

No. Use of POPs are not associated with any risk of cancers.

6. Can POPs lower my sex drive?

Not always. Sex drive in women is dependent on many factors including health status, social economic and the relationship with companion.



7. What should I do if I forget to take my POPs?

You should take your pill as soon as you remember and continue taking your pills at the usual time. For further guidance call or visit your health care provider.

Remember!



POPs will not protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



EMERGENCY CONTRACEPTIVE PILLS (ECPs)

1. Can ECPs affect me and my baby if taken when I am pregnant?

No. ECPs will not affect you or an already existing pregnancy.

2. When should I take ECPs?

You should take ECPs immediately after unprotected sexual intercourse. It is more effective if taken early but you can take ECPs within 5 days (120 hrs.) of unprotected sexual intercourse.

3. Can I use ECPs frequently?

When used repeatedly effectiveness of ECPs reduces, therefore it is advisable to use a more effective regular family planning method to prevent pregnancy.

4. Can I use ECPs if I am on anti-retrovirals?

Yes. Women on antiretroviral therapy can safely use ECPs.

5. Where can I get ECPs?

You can get ECPs from your nearest health facility or chemist.

Remember!



ECPs will not protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



INJECTABLE CONTRACEPTIVES

1. If I am HIV positive, can I use injectable contraceptives?

Yes. It is safe for you to use injectable contraceptives but it is also important to use condoms for more protection.

2. If I missed my periods while on injectable contraceptives, does it mean I am pregnant?

Most probably you are NOT pregnant. Consistent use of injectable contraceptives may lead to absence of your monthly periods. However, if it worries you, consult your health care provider.

3. If I am breastfeeding can I use injectable contraceptives?

Yes. You can start using injectable contraceptives when the baby is six weeks old while breastfeeding as it does not affect breast milk production.

4. Will my weight change while using Injectable contraceptives?

Weight change may happen in some women however; weight gain or loss differs from one woman to another. If it worries you, consult your health care provider

5. Can Injectable contraceptives affect me and my baby if administered while I am pregnant?

No. Injectable contraceptives will not affect you and your baby if you are pregnant. However, you should stop Injectables as soon as you know you are pregnant.



6. Will I become infertile if I use injectable contraceptives for a long time?

No. You may experience a delay in becoming pregnant (up to 5 months on average) but not infertility.

7. Can I get cancer if I am using Injectable contraceptives?

No. Use of injectable contraceptives is not associated with any risk of cancers.

9. Can I switch from one injectable to another?

Yes. Switching Injectables is safe and it does not decrease effectiveness. The health care provider will assess your eligibility for other injectable contraceptives.

10. Can injectable contraceptives lower my sex drive?

Not always, Sex drive in women is dependent on many factors including health status, social economic and the relationship with partner. However, if it worries you consult your health care provider.

11. How early or late can I return for my next injection?

It is advisable receive the next injections on time, however if you are late for the next injection the health care provider can assess you and continue providing the subsequent injections.



Ministry of Health

Remember!



Injectable contraceptives cannot protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



IMPLANTS

1. Where are implants inserted?

Implants are inserted on the inner part of the upper arm of non-dominant hand using a simple procedure.

2. Will I feel pain during implant insertion?

No. During implant insertion, the health care provider will administer pain management medicines to minimize pain during the procedure.

3. How long will implants remain in my arm after insertion?

Implants can remain in your arm for up to 3–5 years before removal. However, you can have implants removed any time you decide to remove.

4. Can I get cancer if I am using Implants?

No. Use of implants are not associated with any risk of cancers.

5. How long will I take to become pregnant after the implants are removed?

You can become pregnant almost immediately, however, there can be delay before you become pregnant.



6. Will I experience a lot of monthly bleeding if I use implants?

You may experience bleeding changes which are not harmful and usually resolve with time when using implants. You may experience slightly increased or decreased monthly bleeding. However, should your bleeding be more than usual, consult a health care provider.

7. Will implants move or disappear in my arm?

No, Implants are inserted by trained providers and remain in same position in the arm until they are removed. Sometimes, you may not feel the implants on your arm but a health care provider will help locate them at a health facility.

8. When can I start using implants after child birth?

You can start using implants immediately after child birth. It is important you are assessed by a health care provider for suitability for implants.

9. Can my weight allow me to use implants?

Yes. Implants can be used irrespective of weight. However if you're concerned about your weight consult your health care provider.

10. How soon can I use my arm after implant insertion?

You can do your usual work immediately after leaving the clinic, however you should avoid lifting heavy objects for 1-2 days after implants insertion and keep the insertion site dry for 5 days.



11. Can I use implants if I am on other medicines?

Yes. However, you should inform the health care provider for assessment and suitability for implants.

Remember!



Implants cannot protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



INTRA-UTERINE DEVICES (IUDs)

1. Will I be at risk of getting STIs if I use IUDs?

No, but having multiple partners when you are using IUDs increase your chances of getting STIs.

2. If I experience change in my vaginal discharge or have a foul smelling discharge while using IUDs will it be removed?

No. If you experience unusual discharge or smell kindly consult your health care provider promptly for treatment and you will continue using IUDs to prevent unplanned pregnancy.

3. Will IUDs prevent me from getting STIs/HIV?

No. IUDs will NOT prevent you from getting STIs/HIV but will prevent you from becoming pregnant.

4. How soon will I become pregnant after removing IUD?

You will become pregnant almost immediately after removal of IUDs.

5. Can I use IUDs If I have never been pregnant before?

Yes. You can generally use an IUD even when you have not been pregnant before.



6. Will an IUD move in my uterus during sexual intercourse or exercise?

No, the IUD will stay intact in your uterus once inserted by a trained provider.

7. Will the IUD be expelled during my monthly periods?

The IUD will rarely be expelled during monthly periods however; you are advised to routinely check your pads during monthly periods.

8. Can my partner feel the IUD during sexual intercourse?

No, IUDs are inserted by a skilled health care provider and your partner will not feel them during sexual intercourse.

9. When can I have an IUD inserted?

You can have an IUD inserted any time as long as you are not pregnant and you have been assessed for suitability.

10. Will I experience increased monthly bleeding if I use IUDs?

You may experience bleeding changes which are not harmful and usually resolve with time when using IUDs. You may experience lightly increased or decreased monthly bleeding. However, should your bleeding be more than usual, consult a health care provider.



11. Where can I get an IUD inserted?

You can get an IUD inserted at any nearest health facility with a trained provider. Consult your nearest health care provider for more information.

Remember!



IUDs cannot protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



BILATERAL TUBAL LIGATION (BTL)

1. Will my monthly periods change if I undergo BTL?

No. You will continue getting your monthly periods as usual.

2. Will BTL lower my sex drive?

No. You will continue experiencing your sexual drive as usual

3. Can I have BTL reversed in the future?

No, BTL is a permanent method whose reversal is not easy

4. Will I feel a lot of pain during BTL procedure?

No. BTL is a minor surgical procedure with minimal pain and bleeding. The health care provider will administer pain management medicines before the procedure.

5. Where on my body will BTL be performed?

BTL involves the cutting, tying and blocking of your fallopian tubes.

6. Where can I get BTL done?

You can get BTL done at a health facility with a trained provider and equipment. Consult your nearest health facility for information.



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Remember!



BTL cannot protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



VASECTOMY

1. Will Vasectomy affect my sexual desire?

No. After Vasectomy your sexual function will remain the same.

2. Should I go for Vasectomy even when I have no children?

Yes, you can have vasectomy as long as you have the desire to have no children at all.

3. Can I have Vasectomy reversed if decide to have a child in the future?

No, Vasectomy is a permanent method whose reversal is not easy if you desire to have children in the future.

4. Will I feel a lot of pain if I undergo Vasectomy?

No. Vasectomy is a minor surgical procedure with minimal pain and bleeding. The health care provider will administer pain management medicines before the procedure.

5. Where on my body will Vasectomy be performed?

Vasectomy involves the cutting, tying and blocking of your sperm ducts.



6. How long should I wait before resuming un-protected sexual intercourse after Vasectomy?

It is advisable for a man to abstain or use a barrier method for 90 days following vasectomy before resuming un-protected sexual intercourse to prevent unplanned pregnancy.

7. Where can I get Vasectomy services?

You can get Vasectomy done at a health facility with a trained provider and equipment. Consult your nearest health facility for information.

Remember!



Vasectomy cannot protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



FERTILITY AWARENESS METHODs (FAMs)

1. What are Fertility Awareness Methods (FAMs)?

FAMs are a natural family planning methods that helps a woman track her ovulation and identify fertile days within which the couple can abstain or use condoms to prevent unplanned pregnancy.

2. Can I use FAMs?

Yes, you can use FAMs if you do not want or you are not eligible for hormonal methods and desires to use natural family methods.

3. How can I use FAMs?

You will be trained to track and monitor your ovulation cycle to identify your fertile days and be guided what to do within the cycle. Consult your health care provider for information on FAMs.

4. Will I become pregnant during my menses if I had unprotected sexual intercourse?

Not likely, your chances of becoming pregnant are extremely low during menses but pregnancy has been reported in a few women during menses.

5. Will I become pregnant when using FAMs?

It is possible for you to become pregnant while using FAMs especially if you and your partner cannot abstain or use a condom during fertile days and if you have irregular menses.



6. How long should I abstain from sexual intercourse when using FAMs?

The number of fertile days within which a woman is required to abstain or use a barrier method varies based on the woman's cycle length. Your health care provider will give you more guidance during your assessment and training on FAMs.

Remember!



FAM cannot protect you from STIs/HIV. Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV.



LACTATIONAL AMENORRHEA METHOD (LAM)

1. What is Lactational Amenorrhea Method (LAM)?

LAM is a family planning method based on exclusive breastfeeding. It provides contraception for the mother up to 6 months and best feeding option for the baby.

For LAM to be effective you have to:

- Be exclusively breastfeed your baby
- Your baby should be less than six months
- Your menses should not have resumed

2. Can I use LAMs?

Yes, you can use LAMs if you do not want or you are not eligible for hormonal methods and desires to use natural family methods.

3. How can I use LAMs?

You have to meet the 3 requirements of:

- Exclusive breastfeeding,
- Your baby should be less than 6 months and
- Your monthly periods should not have resumed.

Consult your health care provider for more information.

5. Can LAM be an effective method of family planning?

Yes. LAM is effective if the woman's monthly bleeding has not returned, she is fully or nearly fully breastfeeding, and her baby is less than 6 months old.



6. Will I abstain from sexual intercourse when using LAM?

You do not need to abstain when using LAM and meet all the 3 requirements for effectiveness

7. When should I switch to another method when using LAM?

Ideally, when the baby is 6 months and older, but you can switch to another more effective method as soon as any of the 3 requirements are not being met.

8. Can I use LAM if I work away from home?

Yes. Women who are able to keep their infants with them at work or near by and are able to breast feed frequently can rely on LAM as long as they meet all 3 criteria for LAM.

9. Can I use LAM if I am living with HIV?

Yes. You can safely use LAM as long as you can exclusively breast feed. The risk of mother to child transmission of HIV is low.

Remember!



LAM cannot protect you from STIs/HIV Use condoms to prevent STIs/HIV



CONDOMS

1. Are condoms effective against HIV and other sexually transmitted infections (STIs)?

Yes. Condoms have been proven to provide protection against sexually transmitted infections (STIs). Infact, condoms are the only contraceptive method that also provides protection against STI.

2. Are condoms tested for quality?

Yes. Condoms are tested by both manufacturers and regulatory agencies in our country. These include electronic testing, the water leak test, the air burst test and the strength test.

3. If I don't use a condom all the time during sexual intercourse, will I be protected from STIs, including HIV?

No. You will be required to use condoms for every sexual intercourse for protection against STIs/HIV.

4. Can I use two condoms to better prevent pregnancy and protect myself from STIs/HIV?

No. using two condoms at the same time-either two male condoms or a male and female condom-is not a good idea as the friction may result in tearing of one or both of the condoms.



5. Will my condom break and slip off frequently?

No. When used as required, condoms will not slip off or break frequently

6. Can water affect effectiveness of condoms?

Water that contains chemicals such as chlorine, or additives such as soap, bath oil or bubble bath will affect the condom material (Latex)

7. Will I experience less sexual pleasure when using condoms?

Not exactly, but some people may find condoms interfering with sensation.

8. Will male and female condoms provide the same protection against HIV?

Yes. Both male and female condoms are effective in preventing STIs/HIV. Male and female condoms should not be used at the same time.

9. If my sexual partner and I have HIV, do we need to use condoms?

Yes. People who have HIV still need protection from STDs and may want to prevent pregnancy. Condoms also protect against exposure to different types of HIV.



10. Can I use a condom more than once?

No. A condom can only be used once. Use a new condom every time you have sexual intercourse for protection of STIs/HIV and prevention of pregnancy.

11. Where can I get condoms?

You can get condoms from your nearest health facility, chemist or shop.

Remember!



CONDOMS protect you from STIs/HIV and prevents pregnancy.

